TROFIE AL PESTO GENOVESE

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**1 h 30 min plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Semolina dough
180 g	Pine nuts
210 g	Basil leaves, plus more to garnish
5 g	Garlic
150 g	Olive oil
36 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
36 g	Fiore sardo, finely grated, plus more to finish
36 g	Pecorino romano, finely grated

METHOD

1. Roll 624 g of trofie from the semolina dough.
2. Set the oven to 325°F. Scatter the pine nuts across a sheet pan in one layer and toast them 5 to 7 minutes, to a very pale gold. Look at them every couple of minutes so they do not catch. Let them cool, about 15 minutes.
3. Put a large pot of water on to boil over high heat and salt it heavily. Sit a colander in an ice water bath alongside.
4. Drop the basil into the pot for 5 seconds, lift it straight out and plunge it into the ice water to stop it cooking.
5. Squeeze the water out of the basil and puree it smooth in a high-speed blender. A splash of water gets the blades moving if it stalls.
6. Add 150 g of the pine nuts and blend until they disappear into the puree.
7. Scrape the basil and pine nut puree into a large mixing bowl. Grate the garlic clove in on a Microplane. Fold in the olive oil and all three cheeses until the pesto is smooth and even.
8. Weigh out 320 g of pesto and leave it in the bowl for the pasta. The remainder keeps 3 days refrigerated in a container under a layer of olive oil. Coarsely chop the last 30 g of pine nuts.
9. Bring a second large pot of water to the boil over high heat and salt it heavily.
10. Cook the trofie 3 to 5 minutes, until tender with some chew left in them.
11. Lift the pasta straight into the bowl of pesto with a spider and turn it gently. Add 55 to 78 g of the pasta water a little at a time, until the pesto coats every piece easily.
12. Divide into bowls and finish with more grated fiore sardo, the chopped pine nuts and basil leaves.

NOTES

> Pesto al Genovese runs on seven things: salt, garlic, olive oil, Genovese basil, pine nuts, parmigiano-reggiano and pecorino sardo. Fiore sardo, the gently smoky Sardinian pecorino, is what carries this version.
> Five seconds in boiling water and a plunge into ice sets the color of the basil, so the pesto stays green instead of going dark.
> Trofie is the shape pesto meets most often along the Ligurian Riviera. Linguine, called trenette there, is the other common pairing.
> Versions along that coast vary widely. Some add green beans and potatoes to the pot, and the pesto itself ranges from chunky and raw out of a mortar to as smooth as peanut butter.

SHAPE
Trofie

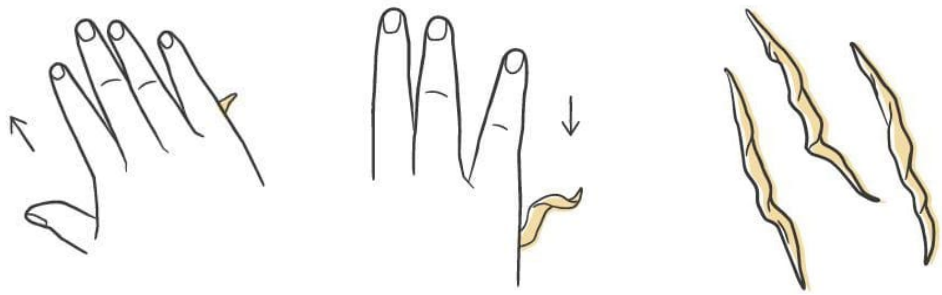
Region: Liguria, on the eastern Riviera around Recco and Camogli / Rest: 1 to 2 hours at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make semolina dough. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Set the dough on the work surface under plastic wrap or a towel, left loose so you can pull pieces off as you go.
3. Pinch off a piece about the size of a shelled peanut and set it on the board in front of you. Leave the board unfloured, unlike other shapes; this one is formed in a single motion and needs the friction. Add the barest dusting only if the dough is tacky and sticking.
4. With the outside edge of your palm, roll the piece up and away at 45 degrees, using moderate pressure and a gentle rocking motion. Right-handed cooks angle left, left-handed cooks angle right. Then bring it straight down at 90 degrees, parallel to the bottom edge of the board, pressing harder as your palm's outer edge drags down.

5. As the piece travels down, it curls into a small spiral tapered at both ends against the edge of your palm. This will not work on the first few tries. It takes a lot of repetition to land the angle and pressure together.
6. Lay the finished pasta on the sheet pan in a single layer.
7. Shape the rest of the dough.
8. Dry 1 to 2 hours at room temperature, until the pasta stiffens slightly and holds its shape when handled.
9. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3

NOTES

Piece size is about a shelled peanut. Finished spirals run 1 to 2 inches long, tapered to a point at each end.
No tool. The gesture is a rub with the outside edge of the palm against a bare board, up at 45 degrees then down at 90 degrees, in one continuous motion. The name comes from strofinare, to rub.
Leave the board unfloured on purpose. The wood's friction both forms the spiral and gives the surface texture that holds sauce.
Beginner alternative: roll a jelly-bean-size piece between two palms. Easier, but the result is smoother and grips less sauce.
For chestnut trofie, swap 100g of the tipo 00 in the semolina dough for the same weight of chestnut flour. The book's own chestnut dough is egg based and will not work for this shape.
Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
Pesto al Genovese is the pairing, and chestnut trofie with pesto is the version worth chasing. Tomato sauces also suit this delicate shape.

DOUGH

Semolina Dough

Makes: 750 g / Active Time: 10-15 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

325 g	Tipo 00 flour
175 g	Semolina flour
250 g	Lukewarm water
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together thoroughly, then mound on a wooden surface with a well 5 to 6 inches across.
2. Add the water slowly. Water has no body of its own, so it escapes far more easily than yolks do.
3. Draw in flour from the inner wall with a fork as you pour, working round the circumference until all the water is in.
4. Knead 10 to 15 minutes, pressing down and away, rotating, folding.
5. Add water by the tablespoon only if it stays dry.
6. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

Eggless, so it stays more elastic and less tender than egg dough. Do not expect the Play-Doh feel here.
50% hydration against 500 g total flour.
65% of the flour is 00 and 35% semolina.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.